CITY OF LARKSPUR
Staff Report

June 3, 2026, City Council Meeting

DATE: May 20, 2026

TO: Honorable Mayor Andre and the Larkspur City Council

FROM: Ruben Martin, Fire Chief
Jason Weber, RVPA Executive Officer

SUBJECT: ADOPTION OF RESOLUTION NO. 46/26 OF THE CITY COUNCIL OF THE CITY OF LARKSPUR, CALIFORNIA CALLING AND GIVING NOTICE OF THE HOLDING OF AN ELECTION TO BE HELD ON NOVEMBER 3, 2026 AND REQUESTING THE BOARD OF SUPERVISORS OF THE COUNTY OF MARIN TO CONSOLIDATE SAID ELECTION; AND AUTHORIZE THE CLERK OR THE DULY AUTHORIZED OFFICER(S) AND AGENCY TO CARRY OUT ALL THE NECESSARY PROCEDURES FOR SAID ELECTION SUBMITTING TO THE VOTERS THE QUESTION RELATING TO A SPECIAL TAX FOR PARAMEDIC SERVICES.

ACTION REQUESTED

Approve Resolution 46/26 calling and giving notice of the holding of an election to be held on November 3, 2026, and request the Board of Supervisors of the County of Marin consolidate said election; and authorize the Clerk or his/her duly authorized officers and agency to carry out all the necessary procedures for said election submitting to the voters the question relating to a special tax for paramedic services.

BACKGROUND

The RVPA is an eight-member joint powers authority (JPA) established in 1982 for the purpose of delivering Fire Department paramedic services in the Ross Valley. The eight member communities of the RVPA are: Corte Madera, Kentfield, San Anselmo, Fairfax, Larkspur, Ross, Sleepy Hollow and unincorporated areas (CSA 27) in the Ross Valley area.

The RVPA JPA is one of the oldest and most successful regional partnerships in Marin County. The JPA was established in 1982 to share costs among the member agencies to provide Fire Department based paramedic first response and ambulance transport services to the communities in the Ross Valley. Since its launch, the JPA has evolved to continually provide exceptional levels of advanced life support care to our residents and visitors.

It is important to note that Fire Department based paramedic response holds service to our communities and patient care as our foremost objective. The seamless combination of Fire Department paramedic engine companies and ambulance units ensures for rapid and highly professional levels of care.

DISCUSSION

Special Tax

The primary funding mechanism for the RVPA is a parcel tax. Each taxable residential unit is taxed along with every 1,000 square feet of non-residential structures. This special tax-funding structure has been in place since the inception of the RVPA and provides a significant portion of the approximately $3.8 million annual budget.

Every four years, the voters who reside within the JPA member communities are required to vote to fund the tax for a four-year period. The current tax expires on June 30, 2027.

To maintain the RVPA revenue stream, each JPA member agency must place the matter on a ballot before the June 30, 2027, date. The City of Larkspur has moved to even year elections per SB 415 which is a much less expensive election option since it is consolidated with the statewide elections. RVPA would like to move forward this year with tax measure to make the election costs as minimal as possible.

Under California law, cities may impose special taxes only when the measure is approved by 2/3 of the voters voting in the election. (Cal. Gov. Code § 53722; see also Cal. Gov. Code § 50077(a)).

In June 2022, the RVPA proposed and the voters in all member agency jurisdictions (excluding Corte Madera) approved the current tax rate containing $3 annual increases as follows:

2023-24	$94.50
2024-25	$97.50
2025-26	$100.50
2026-27	$103.50

ANALYSIS

For the next four years, beginning in 2027, the RVPA Board of Directors has approved a tax rate containing up to a $4 annual increase as follows:

2027-28	$107.50
2028-29	$111.00
2029-30	$114.50
2030-31	$118.00

Annually, each member agency confirms the tax. At that time, the RVPA and staff from member agencies assess the financial condition of the RVPA and then make a recommendation on the rate for the next one-year period. If the financial condition of the paramedic program is stable, the JPA and member agencies can maintain the tax at its present level and defer the annual increase approved by the voters. This has

been done in the past. Thus, while voters approve annual incremental increases, the JPA and member agencies can hold the tax at a lower level.

Proposed Ballot Language

The RVPA Board has approved the following ballot language for use by the member agencies:

"To maintain rapid 9-1-1 emergency response times and preserve the number of on-duty paramedics ready to respond to accidents/medical emergencies, shall the Ross Valley Paramedic Authority measure be adopted continuing for four years the paramedic services special tax of up to $107.50 / residential living unit or 1,000 square feet of developed nonresidential property, adjusted up to $4.00/ year, generating approximately $834,000 annually, with annual audits, public spending disclosure and all funds for local paramedic services?

The Ross Valley Paramedic Authority has provided excellent paramedic services to the Ross Valley since 1982, and the action requested of the City Council would place a measure on the ballot to continue those services for another four years.

Election

According to the Marin Registrar of Voters, the cost to place an item on the consolidated general election ballot ranges from $19,000 to $38,000 or approximately $3.00 per registered voter depending on the number of items on the ballot and the number of jurisdictions who participate in the election.

Election Timing

Dates	Deadlines
August 7th	Last day to file resolution consolidating election
August 17th	Deadline for submission of primary arguments to City Clerk and for receipt of City Attorney's analysis.
August 24th	Deadline for submission of rebuttal arguments to City Clerk.

Campaign

It is important for the City Council to keep in mind that public resources may not be used for ballot measure campaign activities. If the Council adopts the attached resolution to put the measure on the November 3, 2026, ballot, City officials may not engage in campaign activities while on City time or use City resources to advocate for the measure.

FISCAL IMPACT

It is estimated that holding an election during a statewide primary will cost approximately $19,000 to $38,000 or $3.00 per registered voter. The City Manager believes there is sufficient capacity in the General Fund to cover this expense.

ENVIRONMENTAL IMPACT

Adoption of the attached resolution is exempt from the California Environmental Quality Act, Public Resources Code section 21000 et seq. ("CEQA"), because it can be seen with certainty that there is no

possibility that the activity authorized herein may have a significant effect on the environment. (CEQA Guidelines §15061(b)(3)).

STAFF RECOMMENDATIONS

Approve the attached resolution.

Respectfully submitted,
Ruben Martin, Fire Chief
Jason Weber, RVPA Executive Officer

Attachments
1. Resolution 46/26
2. Ballot Argument for Paramedic Tax Renewal

CITY OF LARKSPUR
RESOLUTION 46/26

A RESOLUTION OF THE CITY COUNCIL OF CITY OF LARKSPUR CALLING FOR A MUNICIPAL ELECTION TO BE HELD IN ITS JURISDICTION ON NOVEMBER 3, 2026, FOR THE PURPOSE OF SUBMITTING TO THE VOTERS A MEASURE AUTHORIZING THE CONTINUATION OF A SPECIAL PARCEL TAX FOR PARAMEDIC SERVICES AND REQUESTING THE MARIN COUNTY BOARD OF SUPERVISORS TO CONSOLIDATE SAID ELECTION WITH THE GENERAL ELECTION CONDUCTED ON THAT DATE

WHEREAS, the Ross Valley Paramedic Authority ("RVPA") is an eight member California Joint Powers Authority formed by agreement in 1982 pursuant to the California Joint Exercise of Powers Act, Gov. Code, §§ 6500 *et seq.*, by and among the Cities/Towns of Corte Madera, Larkspur, Fairfax, Ross, and San Anselmo; the Kentfield Fire Protection District; the Sleepy Hollow Fire Protection District; and the County of Marin ("Member Agencies") for the purpose of providing paramedic and pre-hospital emergency medical services throughout and across the Member Agencies' jurisdictional boundaries by a single, consolidated agency; and

WHEREAS, the City of Larkspur has been a Member Agency of RVPA since its inception over 40 years ago; and

WHEREAS, the community has consistently received responsive, high-quality paramedic and pre-hospital emergency medical care from RVPA and the City Council of the City of Larkspur wishes to maintain and ensure this service into the future; and

WHEREAS, RVPA is funded largely with tax revenues from its Member Agencies; and

WHEREAS, a statewide election will be held on November 3, 2026 ("General Election"); and

WHEREAS, California Government Code section 53722 allows the City of Larkspur to submit to the voters a proposition for the imposition of a special tax to be approved by a two-thirds vote of the voters voting in an election on the issue; and

WHEREAS, the voters of the City of Larkspur have consistently voted in favor of the RVPA special tax for paramedic services and last approved such a tax in 2022; and

WHEREAS, the monies from the RVPA special tax are used exclusively for paramedic and pre-hospital emergency care services; and

WHEREAS, through the adoption of this Resolution, the City Council of the City of Larkspur desires to propose to its voters the renewal of an additional four years of the special tax as set forth below at the November 3, 2026 election; and

WHEREAS, pursuant to California Elections Code sections 10403 *et seq.*, the City Council of the City of Larkspur may request consolidation of the election with any and all

other elections to be held on November 3, 2026, and may request that the Marin County Registrar of Voters perform certain election services; and

WHEREAS, the City of Larkspur desires that the election on the special tax measure be consolidated with the statewide General Election to be held on November 3, 2026; and

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED as follows:

SECTION 1. RECITALS. The above recitals are true and correct and incorporated as findings herein.

SECTION 2. ELECTION CALLED AND BALLOT QUESTION. There is hereby called and ordered to be held in the City of Larkspur of California on Tuesday, November 3, 2026, a General Municipal Election at which election the issue presented to the voters of the City of Larkspur in the form of the following question shall be:

To maintain rapid 9-1-1 emergency response times and preserve the number of on-duty paramedics ready to respond to accidents/medical emergencies, shall the Ross Valley Paramedic Authority measure be adopted continuing for four years the paramedic services special tax of up to $107.50 / residential living unit or 1,000 square feet of developed nonresidential property, adjusted up to $4.00/ year, generating approximately $834,000 annually, with annual audits, public spending disclosure and all funds for local paramedic services?	YES
	NO

SECTION 4. IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS. The City of Larkspur City Attorney is hereby directed to prepare an impartial analysis of the ballot measure showing the effect of the measure on the existing law and operation of the measure.

SECTION 5. BALLOT ARGUMENT. Pursuant to Article 4, Chapter 3, Division 9 of the Elections Code, an argument in favor of the ballot measure shall be submitted on behalf of the City of Larkspur. The deadline to file arguments for or against the measure is August 17, 2026. Arguments shall be submitted to the City Clerk of the City of Larkspur and shall not exceed 300 words in length. The clerk upon receipt of arguments, and after the filing deadline, shall immediately transmit copies to any known opposing parties who may then submit rebuttals. If one or more arguments are submitted in favor or against the measure, arguments shall be selected pursuant to Elections Code section 9287, and if more than one argument shares the same priority, random selection shall be used.

SECTION 6. REBUTTAL ARGUMENT. The last day for filing rebuttal arguments shall be August 24, 2026, with the City Clerk of the City of Larkspur and shall not exceed 250 words in length. Pursuant to Elections Code section 9285(a), when the arguments for and

against the measure have been selected, the City Clerk shall send a copy of the argument in favor of the measure to the authors of the argument against the measure, and a copy of an argument against the measure to the authors of the argument in favor of the measure.

SECTION 7. BALLOT FORMAT. The ballots to be used at the election shall be in the form and content as required by law.

SECTION 8. HOURS OF POLLING. The polls for the election shall be opened at 7:00 a.m. on the day of the election and shall remain open continuously until 8:00 p.m. of the same day at such time when the polls shall be closed.

SECTION 9. REQUESTING CONSOLIDATION OF ELECTIONS. Pursuant to Elections Code section 10403, the Board of Supervisors of the County of Marin is hereby requested to consolidate the General Municipal Election on Tuesday, November 3, 2026 with the statewide General Election to be held on the same date, provide all services necessary for this election, and print ballots including the ballot measure set forth herein. The election shall be conducted in all respects as if one election, and one form of ballot shall be used.

SECTION 10. NOTICE TO COUNTY OF MARIN. The City Clerk is hereby authorized and directed to file a certified copy of this Resolution with the Marin County Board of Supervisors and the Registrar of the County of Marin, pursuant to Elections Code section 10403.

SECTION 11. NOTICE OF ELECTION. The City Clerk is hereby authorized and directed to give notice of the election as required by law.

SECTION 12. CERTIFICATION. The City Clerk shall certify to the passage and adoption of this Resolution and enter it into the book of original resolutions.

SECTION 13. EXECUTION. The City Manager of the City of Larkspur is hereby authorized and directed to do any and all things necessary to execute and deliver any and all documents necessary or advisable in order to complete the process for placing the measure on the November 3, 2026 ballot.

SECTION 14. SEVERABILITY. If any section, subsection, sentence, clause, phrase, or portion of this Resolution is for any reason held to be invalid or unconstitutional by the decision of any court, such decision shall not affect the validity of the remaining portions of this Resolution. The City Council hereby declares that it would have adopted this Resolution and each section, subsection, sentence, clause, and phrase irrespective of the fact that any one or more of same be declared invalid and unconstitutional.

IT IS HEREBY CERTIFIED that the City Council of the City of Larkspur duly introduced and regularly adopted the foregoing resolution at a regular meeting held on June 3, 2026, by the following vote:

AYES: COUNCILMEMBER:

NOES: COUNCILMEMBER:

ABSENT: COUNCILMEMBER:

ABSTAIN: COUNCILMEMBER:

_____
Stephanie Andre, Mayor

ATTEST:

_____
Alison Foulis, City Clerk

Vote Yes on _ to maintain rapid 9-1-1 emergency response times.

Since 1982 the voters of the Ross Valley have overwhelmingly supported local voter-approved funding for paramedic services. Unless renewed by voters, this funding will expire next year and local paramedic services must be reduced.

Voting Yes on _ renews local paramedic funding for four more years at the current tax rate with modest annual increases of no more than $4 per year.

Voting Yes on _ will:

- Maintain rapid 9-1-1 emergency response times
- Preserve the number of on- duty paramedics ready to respond to accidents and medical emergencies
- Maintain access to lifesaving emergency medical training and equipment for local paramedics

Measure_ continues fiscal accountability and local control:

- All funds must stay in the Ross Valley for paramedic services only and cannot be diverted
- No funds can be taken away by the state or federal governments
- Annual audits and public spending disclosure ensure funds are spent as promised

When created 44 years ago, the Ross Valley Paramedic Authority operated a single ambulance. Today, local paramedic care is provided through state-of-the-art paramedic ambulance units with trained paramedics aboard fire engines so that advanced emergency care arrives as quickly as possible.

The Ross Valley Paramedic Authority is a partnership of eight Ross Valley communities that have combined efforts to ensure exceptional emergency medical response for the safety of our communities. While paramedic services are partially funded by collections from insurance companies and billing of nonresidents, the current level of service cannot continue without Measure_.

For victims of heart attacks, strokes, accidents, and other emergencies, rapid 9-1-1 paramedic response can be the difference between life and death. You never know when an accident or medical emergency will occur. Vote Yes on _ to ensure rapid 9-1-1 paramedic response is ready when you or a loved one needs it the most.